Dalya Elmalt

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University of Wisconsin–Madison
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Citizenship: Egypt

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison
Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
M.S. in Economics — 2024
Institute for Research on Poverty, Graduate Research Fellow

University of Chicago
M.A. in Social Sciences (Economics) — 2017
B.A. in Economics — 2016

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Risk and Insurance Markets

References

Ashley Swanson (Advisor)
Professor of Economics
UW–Madison
608-262-5897
swanson25@wisc.edu

Alan Sorensen
Professor of Economics
UW–Madison
608-263-3867
sorensen@ssc.wisc.edu

Naoki Aizawa
Associate Professor of Economics
UW–Madison
608-262-9250
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Job Market Paper

The Doctor's Pen and the Payer's Bargain: Insurer Ownership of Primary Care

Lawmakers are considering bans on insurer ownership of physician practices. Such vertical integration can be efficient, if it eliminates double marginalization and the savings reach premiums, or harmful, if it raises rivals' costs or inflates government subsidies. I study a national insurer's 2020 acquisition of the largest chain of primary care clinics in a local Oregon market, using claims that observe every insurer's prices and patients at the same primary care providers. Relative to independent practices, rival insurers pay the acquired clinics about 13 percent more for the same commercial office visit. The acquired clinics record more diagnoses for the acquiring insurer's Medicare Advantage enrollees than for rival insurers' enrollees, raising Medicare's payments for them. The acquiring insurer does not negotiate lower hospital prices, and the acquired clinics refer its enrollees to specialists about 21 percent less often than rival insurers' enrollees. Its Medicare Advantage premiums do not fall relative to rivals'. In a market with typical hospital and physician concentration but fragmented commercial insurers, integration raises what rival insurers and Medicare pay, while any savings do not reach the acquiring insurer's Medicare Advantage enrollees through lower premiums or more generous benefits.

Working Papers

Do Self-Funded Employers Pay More for Hospital Care? Evidence from Transparency in Coverage Data

ESG Investing: Only Part of the Climate Puzzle (with Deniz Igan and Divya Kirti)
CEPR Discussion Paper 16061, 2021; revised September 2023.
Earlier version: IMF Working Paper 21/112, "Limits to Private Climate Change Mitigation," 2021

Presentations

UW–Madison IO Workshop; International Monetary Fund

Teaching Experience

University of Wisconsin–Madison

TA, Principles of Macroeconomics – Carter Braxton	Spring 2025
Head TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026
TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Rebecca Glawtschew	Spring 2023
TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Officer, International Monetary Fund	2019–2021
Junior Research Scientist, Finance Department, New York University	2017–2019
Research Assistant, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago	2015

Service

Co-organizer, Student IO Seminar, UW–Madison

Honors and Awards

Outstanding Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UW–Madison	2025
Jeff Metcalf Summer Research Award, University of Chicago	2015
Sawiris Scholar	2013–2016

Additional

Restricted-use data: Oregon All Payer All Claims database (APAC)
Programming: Python, Stata, R, Julia, SQL/DuckDB, Hadoop/MapReduce, LaTeX
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent)

Last updated November 2026